David Morgan-Gumm

Data & AI Engineer

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PROFILE

Data & AI Engineer with eight years building data platforms on Azure, from SQL warehouses to Microsoft Fabric. Promoted three times at Oliver James, finishing as Data Platform Manager leading a team of six. Chose to return to hands-on engineering at Brabners to build with AI as a developer before moving further into senior leadership, and now delivering the firm's data platform and internal applications. Founder of the sql_squared data community and the Echelon web app.

SKILLS

Data platforms: Microsoft Fabric (OneLake, Lakehouse, Data Pipelines, Notebooks), Azure Synapse Analytics, Azure Data Factory, Azure Data Explorer, SQL Server, Azure SQL Database, medallion architecture, dimensional modelling, master data management (Tamr)

Languages: SQL (T-SQL), Python, PySpark, KQL, TypeScript, C#

Cloud: Azure (Functions, Logic Apps, Key Vault, Entra ID), Google Cloud Platform (Cloud Run, Firebase Hosting)

DevOps: GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps YAML pipelines, Bicep, Docker, CI/CD, automated testing

Analytics and AI: Power BI, semantic models, Microsoft Foundry, Azure AI Language, Claude Code, agentic development workflows

Integration: REST, SOAP, OData, GraphQL, event-driven architecture, Salesforce (SOQL), SAP Business ByDesign

Applications: React, Next.js, Node.js (Express), PostgreSQL (Supabase), Drizzle ORM, Stripe

EXPERIENCE

Data & AI Engineer, Brabners, Manchester — Aug 2026 – Present

- Built and launched Central Intelligence Tools, a Next.js and TypeScript application used by 400–500 people to open new matters, with everything needed to work on a matter set up in one place.
- Delivered a new analytical SQL data warehouse on a medallion architecture, now in production, fed by two source systems and running a full Power BI reporting suite.
- Laid the groundwork for bringing more of the firm's business systems onto the platform, towards master data management and Azure adoption.
- Put DevOps foundations in place on GitHub: automated testing, CI/CD pipelines, infrastructure as code in Bicep, branch protection and pull request policies.
- Introduced Claude Code and agentic development to a four-person development team as part of implementing the firm's AI strategy, with tests, CI checks and pull request review gating every change.

Oliver James Manchester — **Feb 2021 – Jul 2026**

Data Platform Manager — Nov 2023 – Jul 2026

- Led a team of six data engineers and developers, including one manager, and owned the roadmap for the data and development functions; mentored two junior engineers through to promotion.
- Migrated the internal data estate from Azure Synapse to Microsoft Fabric (OneLake, Lakehouse, PySpark notebooks, Bicep), bringing major improvements in data quality and master data management.
- Delivered master data management with Tamr on Fabric across 1 million+ people and company records, removing 20–30% duplication and publishing golden records to downstream systems through event-driven and API integrations.
- Built daily LinkedIn job-market analytics on Azure Data Explorer, using Azure AI Language to map skills and industries from job postings for whitespace reporting on unmet talent demand.
- Introduced a development change board, firmer sprint ceremonies and a release plan shared with the business, protecting planned work from ad-hoc requests.
- Managed implementation partners delivering enterprise application suites and public-facing applications, defining requirements for the business-critical integrations.

Data Engineering Lead — Oct 2022 – Oct 2023

- Created the business's DevOps function: Azure DevOps YAML pipelines took all software, data and AI resources from manual releases to fully automated deployment, cutting deployment time by 80%.
- Built an event-driven reporting suite for telephony data across five countries, with call statistics reaching management within seconds; later added AI call transcription summaries using Microsoft Foundry.
- Wrote the long-term data strategy with senior leadership, focused on embedding data in core business processes.

Senior Data Engineer — Oct 2021 – Sep 2022

- Designed and delivered a greenfield Azure Synapse data platform (Data Lake Storage Gen2, Data Factory, dimensional models) serving 1,000+ users across 12+ countries.
- Integrated legacy finance systems with a new SAP Business ByDesign ERP alongside third-party consultancies; automated validation and reconciliation held data accuracy at 99.9%.
- Designed the Salesforce integration, delta-loading sales activity with custom SOQL into the data lake behind core business reporting.

SQL Developer Feb 2021 – Sep 2021

- Built a cloud-first SQL data warehouse during a period of hyper-growth, reverse-engineering legacy systems to keep key business logic.

SQL Developer & Software Tester, Evolution Recruitment, Warrington Jul 2018 – Feb 2021

- Extended the SQL data warehouse behind the in-house CRM and worked on the business's first migration to an Azure data stack.
- Improved software usability and reporting through testing-led fixes, recognised by the business.

PROJECTS AND COMMUNITY

Founder, SQL Squared Ltd (alongside employment) 2024 – Present

- **Echelon** (echelon.sqlsquared.co.uk): a live web app replacing the spreadsheets tabletop Crusade groups use to run their campaigns, with free and paid tiers and its own Discord community.
  TypeScript, React, Express, PostgreSQL (Supabase), Drizzle ORM, Stripe, Vitest, Docker. Runs fully on Google Cloud Platform (Cloud Run, Firebase Hosting). Built with Claude Code as a pair programmer; architecture and review of every change owned end to end.
- **sql_squared** (sqlsquared.co.uk): a community for data and AI professionals, with a podcast interviewing industry practitioners, a YouTube channel and technical articles.

Redgate Community Ambassador May 2025 – Present

- Give product feedback, write and attend events as part of Redgate's ambassador programme for database DevOps tooling.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 2:1, University of Liverpool 2018

Level 5 Management and Leadership, Chartered Management Institute 2026

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900), Microsoft 2019